included in the Mossad's mandate and which it therefore did not have the professional tools to carry out.

The director of the Mossad at that time was Zvi Zamir. He was more in tune than others to the research and evaluation significance of Mossad intelligence because of his military background, in particular the years in which he served as GOC Southern Command. In addition, since he had also served as the head of the IDF's training division, he was able to read the intelligence materials from Egypt and Syria, which dealt with strategic issues, combat doctrine, training, and exercises, with an authoritative eye, and he interpreted them as preparations for war. Moreover, Zamir used to meet selectively, depending on the matter, with the Mossad's top sources in various arenas in order to hear from them directly. He would question them, brief them, and hear the intelligence straight from their mouths, without any "filters"; this enabled him to formulate his opinion according to the net intelligence, without any background noise. We were always taught the adage "It is not forbidden for an intelligence officer to use his intelligence." Zvi Zamir did exactly this by examining and integrating the intelligence that was coming in from a variety of Mossad sources—all of which pointed to war.

I remember that on Friday, October 5, 1973, I returned home just before the beginning of the Sabbath on the eve of Yom Kippur. When I got home, I asked my wife to pack my army backpack for me, because the next morning I would be going off to join the war. I made this statement on the basis of an extraordinary mass of intelligence alerts that had come in from various Mossad sources over the last week. *None of these alerts came from Ashraf Marwan,* though Marwan, son-in-law of former president of Egypt Gamal Abd-El Nasser, and one of the closest aides to Nasser's successor, President Sadat, was one of the best sources of the Mossad. Marwan's last warning came on September 8, 1973, and the next time he reported in was at 21:30 on October 4, in a telephone conversation in which he mentioned the code for war for the first time. On October 6, at 02:55, the office of the head of the Mossad informed the head of Military Intelligence that about half an hour earlier the Mossad had received the code word for war from the source. I will elaborate on the further unfolding of the early warning later in this chapter.

In the late morning of Saturday, October 6, 1973, I was in contact once an hour with the assistant to the head of MI's intelligence-gathering